

Diary

WHAT'S ON IN SYDNEY TODAY

● **DUCK AT THE ZOO:** Well-known jazz group Galapagos Duck will give two concerts at Taronga Zoo's outdoor stage today, at 12.30 and 2. The Duck will be playing excerpts from its latest album, titled *Endangered Species*, which is a dedication to animals either extinct or in danger of extinction. Normal zoo admission charges cover the concert.

● **GUIDED TOUR:** Of history in Windsor and Richmond, organised by the Prospect Trust, departs from the main gates of the B&I property in Greystanes Rd (opposite Doris St) at 8 am today, returning about 5. More information from 625 7103.

● **WHO AND WHERE:** The Australasian chapter of the Dr Who Fan Club meets today, 12.5, at the Stephen Roberts Theatre, Sydney University. Slide shows, displays, stalls, refreshment. \$3 adults, \$2 children.

● **CONSERVATION CALL:** A public meeting in the Glebe Town Hall today (2 pm) will consider submissions to be put to the State Government for changes to the Environmental Planning Act, and will consider formulating a constitution.

● **ART/CRAFT:** St Leo's College, Woolcott Ave, Wahroonga, is holding an art and craft exhibition and sale this weekend (10-15 today). More than 600 paintings have been entered, ranging in price from \$50 to \$25,000.

● **ANTIQUES:** The Parramatta Antique Fair is open today in the

Town Hall (10-6). Items for sale include Victorian and Georgian furniture, clocks, glassware, flags, jewellery, brassware.

● **ROWERS' RUN:** Today's Fun Run will be conducted by the Haberfield Rowing Club, starting from the clubhouse in Dobroyd Parade at 10 am. Prizes for male, female, over 45, and schoolchildren winners.

● **SPEEDBOAT SPECTACULAR:** That's what the St George Motor Boat Club, 2 Wellington St, Sans Souci, is promising today from 10 am. There's an entrance fee of \$10.

● **STAMPS, COINS:** Along with postcards, cards and badges are on sale at a fair in the Turramurra Masonic Hall, 10-4 today.

● **MUSIC, MUSIC:** 1] Midday Music, free, in the Opera House Recording Hall, 11 and noon today, features duo pianists Peter Noye and Helen Krizos. 2] The same artists feature in a lecture/recital for the Australian Society for Keyboard Music, Kuring-gai College of Advanced Education, Eton Rd, Lindfield, 2.30. Mozart, Ravel, Eben and Dvorak. 3] Organist Michael Dymally plays Bach, Mendelssohn and Franck in a recital in the Opera House Concert Hall, today, 3 pm. \$6 and \$4.

4] The St Philip's Players, directed by Michael Dyer, play an all-Telemann program in the church from 2.30. \$5 and \$3.

MELBOURNE

DEAR Mr Packer, Please don't take your bat and ball and go off home. That's not your style. You have had a few Test matches of your own this year and you haven't lost any of them yet.

We do love you for putting both the cricket and the tennis on the air.

You and Mike Willesee rather ganged up there — you murdered poor Mr Duffy on the *Willesee* show. The trouble is, I don't think Mr Duffy knew much about it. I bet he hadn't shown the true marathon courage of sitting up for both the cricket and the tennis all through that brutal nocturnal fortnight.

Only those of us with fearless "desire for the ball" had the strength to do it.

I made it myself only by going to bed at 6 pm, then setting the alarm to get up, refreshed for the bounce, at 11 pm.

I remember only too well the clash with Wimbledon and the cricket. But look, we could have had both with reasonable comfort. Wimbledon still operates in the Victorian era. They don't start tennis until 2 pm, 11 pm our time. So you could have given us the cricket until lunch. Anyway, at Wimbledon it was nearly always raining.

The real reason for not giving us cricket before lunch, I suspect, was ratings and advertising contracts. As a cricket fan I am shocked at my fellow man, but I guess you get better ratings out of shows like *Love Boat* and *The Mike Walsh Show*.

There are those who have to get their dreadful glob of *Love Boat* romance before they can absorb the true serious action of cricket.

You claim that your cover of sport is the best in the world. It probably is, but then you know and I know, that Australians, man for man, are nuttier about sport than any other creatures on earth. Sport to us is the way we establish our national identity. When we pick up victories on sporting fields it helps us conquer our curious national inferiority complex.

I think you discovered very early it was good business to sponsor cricket, tennis and golf, especially cricket. It's what you have done with cricket that has made you the best-known Australian along with Rupert Murdoch, Nellie Melba

DUNSTAN



Keith Dunstan
The Sun,
Melbourne

Good Lord's!
— or an appeal
to Mr Packer on
a silly cut-off

and Ned Kelly. Is there anyone in Britain who hasn't heard of Kerry Packer?

I can quote ladies I know who are bordering on 90 and they are still there watching it at 2 am.

You say the BBC, with its two channels, still doesn't cover it. But the English are different from us, aren't they? Even at Lord's you are lucky to get a crowd of 30,000. They seem to prefer the madness of Soccer.

They haven't the delicious hang-ups that we have. Many of us believe the greatest bliss in life is to witness the thrashing of the Poms. Maybe that's what keeps me up until 3 am. I must confess my eyes begin to glaze over when Messrs Gooch and Gower keep hitting our boys all over the ground.

We used to get the cricket on television given to us by the ABC. I am sure the ABC would be covering it even now except that you outbid them for the rights back in 1979.

Lovely, it was, no advertisements.

We didn't have every over interrupted by that dreadful fellow who is always in a state of ecstasy because he has made an STD call. We didn't get that mum who kept telling her daughter that her hands would no longer look like rats' feet if only she used hand lotion.

We didn't have Bill Peach raving on, strangely comparing the wonders of outback Australia to the three-way goodness of Cadbury's Dairy Milk Chocolate.

We didn't have all those near naked girls and boys in a dangerous state of euphoria jumping over a giant soft drink can. Nor did we get all those replays and those terrible flashbacks. I get confused.

Half the time with your cover I don't know whether they are covering cricket right now, yesterday or tomorrow.

There was that occasion during the second innings. Suddenly Ian Chappell screamed: "He's gone." Gooch was out. "He's got him, he's

BARNES



Mick Barnes,
The Sun-Herald

Mutton Bird
Deterrent
mustn't nest in
White House

Nixon's revelation that he was close to pressing the nuclear button at least four times during his period as President of the United States.

This, together with Ronald Reagan's recent admission that he likes to watch the movie *Rambo* — in which a greasy Sylvester Stallone fulfils the American hawk's most fervent fantasy by returning to Vietnam and winning his own war single-handed, is enough to make you wonder about American Presidents. Are they all cowboys masquerading as politicians?

It seems apparent to me that at least some of the American Presidents suffer from an itchy trigger finger and, as the Mutton Bird Deterrent deflected my brain cells, the solution to this nasty medical problem flashed across the surface of my mind in much the same manner as a ripple-dissolve on the movie screen takes you backward or forward in time.

While fighting off the hazard of feathered invaders I had been pondering an even more awful threat — that of global destruction brought about by nuclear war between the superpowers. This depressing subject had been immediately prompted by Richard

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SUNDAY BEST

PLUS Tanner

WHO SAY IT THEIR WAY

NEW YORK
AS ex-Presidents of the United States go, the only one I'd cross the ocean in order to dine with is that darling of the liberals, Richard Milhous Nixon.

The first time I met him was at Jonathan Aitken's house, where he addressed a Tory philosophy group I head whenever I'm out of prison. We hit it off well, so well in fact that he wrote to me while I was in Pentonville. There is something extremely touching (and rare) about an ex-President writing to one who is banged up. After all, politicians are never there when you need them.

So when I was told I was included in an off-the-record dinner with Nixon I left Annabel's and flew to New York, destination New Jersey, via stops for a weekend tennis tournament in which no-one competing had a good word to say about Tiltac or McEnroe.

The Nixon house is in Saddle River, a very green and beautiful part of New Jersey, one hour from New York City. The house has a Japanese garden of about five acres, a swimming pool that looks like a lotus pond, a tennis court (for the children) and is furnished and covered with the kind of chintzes that Arabs might find vulgar but we English fought the second World War in order to preserve. It is a sprawling house, on one storey, as Mrs Nixon is not in the best of health and cannot climb stairs. The colours are soft browns and yellows, with modern and old mixed up, everything orderly yet cosy. The famous man waited just inside the glass door and came out to greet us as we drove up.

If one wasn't prejudiced against Richard Nixon — which I am — it's all very well to have squalling summit meetings on tax and have brawls with the BLF. We can even overlook the decline in the Australian dollar and cope with the collapse in the ANZUS treaty, but any government which fails to give us television coverage of the cricket is in deadly peril.

I wouldn't vote for it in a fit. Yours sincerely and deeply moved,

KEITH DUNSTAN

MELBOURNE
I HAVE written some gruesome things in this column over the years. Sometimes — especially after visits to poor villages in India or refugee camps in Ethiopia — I have tried to jolt your Sunday morning bacon-and-eggs, complacency.

This week it is time for a good-news story. Despite all the headlined stories about man's inhumanity to man (and God knows there are enough examples of that from Cambodia to Beirut) and despite stories about a dog-eat-dog callousness and selfishness at home and abroad, there are millions of people with hearts as big as Texas and wallets as open as a Texan's mouth.

The "Live Aid to Africa" appeal proved that recently. And as a person involved with a hard-working charity group I can say that Australians are among the most generous in the world. My main charity is the show biz/media/business charity, Variety.

It is rightly billed as "The greatest children's charity in the world."

Worldwide it has been going for around 60 years. Every American president since Franklin Delano Roosevelt has been a member. The world patron is Prince Charles.

Worldwide, Variety has raised more than \$600 million for handicapped and underprivileged kids. You may even have seen our Sunshine coaches transporting handicapped or needy children in your city or town.

It was started by vaudevillians,

TAKI



Taki, The Spectator,
London

Tricky Dicky
and the man
who came to
his dinner

few people are not, thanks to the two greatest novelists since Tolstoy (Woodward has since gone on to greater triumphs, with a hatchet job on the dead Belushi, while Bernstein concentrated on Margaret Jay) — it would be easy to see why the press distrust him. He simply is not good at all at small talk. And as everyone knows, it's charm, small talk and badinage with the reporters, a la JFK, that the American media consider important.

Reagan is a natural at it, Nixon is not, never was. What he is brilliant. There is no other word for him. He knows it all, has seen it all, has met everyone, has had his finger on the button longer than anyone. I only wish Reagan, Carter and Ford had abducted him, stuck him in a large wing of the State Department, fired nine-tenths of the decision makers, let him run our foreign policy and this would be a far better world to live in.

As the meeting was off the record I cannot write about the important things, like Star Wars, and our chances in having an all-out nuclear exchange. Of course Richard Nixon must know that anything said in the presence of eight journalists has little chance of remaining off the record.

We first talked for about 45 minutes, then went into the yellow Chinese room for drinks

HINCH



Derryn Hinch,
Radio 3AW

and that's why each chapter or club is called a tent.

In Australia, Tent 56 started 10 years ago in Sydney with the support of such people as Paul Hogan and Stuart Wagstaff.

I'm biased because I am the Victorian-region president, but I believe Variety is great because it is a way for people put on pedestals by the public and paid fortunes because of that public appeal to give something back.

And giving something back means more than writing a cheque. It means providing your services free at a fund-raising dinner or concert.

In the supposedly bitchy, nasty, ruthless hedonistic, selfish world of show business I have found people with passionate commitment to the cause and an unquenchable desire to help.

Last week for example: In Melbourne, Variety (Victoria), which has only been going for three years, held its Sports Entertainer of the Year awards.

Among the people who turned up and who all paid were Ernie Sigley, Tony Barber, Ron Barassi, Leigh Matthews, Jacki Weaver,

and canapes, then into dinner. That consisted of excellent filet mignon, vegetables, cheese and a very good chocolate mousse. The wine was Chateau Latour '66, "a good year for wines, a bad one for politics", according to our host. From there we went into his study where the mood became more relaxed. He even told us a few anecdotes about the great men of his time.

Curiously enough, Nixon is a dove in domestic politics. He admires Reagan and speaks to him often but is more of a centrist than RR. But when it comes to the Soviet Union he is more of a hawk than the cowboy. (His analysis of the hostage crisis and his opinion on what should have been done was brilliant.) He calls the Soviets nuclear coersers, not fools, nor stupid, just greedy. He thinks that when the Soviets decide to take out the Chinese nuclear capability, it will bring the Western alliance to a terrible dilemma. He knows more about the Soviet Union than all of the CIA put together.

I guess that's why people who don't like to see a strong America still hate and fear him. People like those who want Reagan to resign simply because he's now a semicolon. I only hope they hold their breath till he does.

A good-news
story — and a
baddie nearer
comeuppance

Premier John Cain, Opposition Leader Jeff Kennett, Ian "Molly" Meldrum (who has done more than his share for fundraisers recently) and all the girls from *Sale of the Century*.

The joint winners this year were Lester Ellis and Barry Michael, both champs in their sport and both big-hearted charity workers. That one lunch at the Southern Cross raised nearly \$13,000.

Don't let anyone tell me there is no soul, no conscience, no awareness, in this country.

● Footnote to last week's column:

I wrote about self-confessed paedophile William Allen, a former music teacher. He received a good-behaviour bond after pleading guilty to sexual offences involving children.

He had previous convictions. He claimed in court and on television he had had sex with 2,000 children. He wrote a book about his "pride" in his perversion.

I said in the column that the Director of Public Prosecutions must, for the sake of other children, appeal against the leniency of the sentence. That appeal was lodged on Thursday.



"You will be tried by a jury of your peers, squints and blabbermouths."

CELEBRATE WITH THE Sun

AT THE CITY TO SURF
PRE-RUN PARTY
SYDNEY TOWN HALL
FRIDAY 2ND AUGUST 7-9 PM

The Sun City to Surf is celebrating its 15th Anniversary and all 1985 runners are invited to a giant party. ARE YOU RUNNING THE CITY TO SURF IN FANCY DRESS?

Climb into your costume, come to the pre-run party and you could win: VIP membership to Centre 67 Fitness Club (\$800 value), a home computer or a dinner cruise on Sydney Harbour. Sections for individual adults, individual children, groups.

● Lucky door prizes
● Live music
● Films & aerobics displays

● Interviews with top local & overseas runners including Cliff Young, John Farrington, Rod Dixon & Hugh Jones from the UK
● Budget pasta dinners catered by Rossini's

● Special bargains on running gear. Bring your family along and be part of the City to Surf celebrations.

Admission is FREE to holders of City to Surf runners' identification cards and their families. Book now on 282 6620 or 282 6575.



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